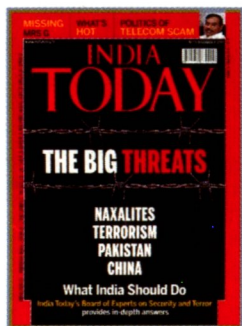


The Big Threats

NOVEMBER 9, 2009

INDIA TODAY's Board of Experts on Security and Terror provides in-depth answers to the key security questions confronting the nation.



“A strong political will coupled with an equally strong and determined leadership is needed to deal with the internal as well as external threats our country faces today.”

MAYA AGARWAL, *Kanpur*

BEST Ideas

INDIA TODAY's efforts to find solutions to the threats India is facing should be helpful to the Government ("The Big Threats", November 9). While hunting the Naxalites, the strategy should be to win over the people. Supply of arms and money should be blocked by holding talks with neighbouring states. The Coast Guard needs to be strengthened further. Dr Manmohan Singh's call for dialogue with Pakistan is welcome. Also, we have to be firm in dealing with China. We hope the Dalai Lama's visit to Tawang sends the right message to China on Arunachal Pradesh. A. J. SAHAYAM, *Thiruvananthapuram*

India's big threats, within the country or from out-



Remembering Indira

India has learnt a lot from Indira Gandhi's successes as well as failures ("Missing Mrs G", November 9). In retrospect, Punjab need not have happened. But Mrs Gandhi's temptation to use it for electoral advantage persuaded her to first foment religious fundamentalism and then allow it to fester to a point where she thought she would be feted for effecting a smooth operation. It didn't happen and she paid for that with her life.

MEGHANA M., *via www.indiatoday.in*

Indira Gandhi built Indo-Soviet relations and was not perturbed by US threats. She was also one of those rare leaders who stood for an independent foreign policy. She was indeed a charismatic leader.

R. MURALIKUMAR, *Chennai*

side, are perennial in nature. There is no magic wand available to shield the country against these threats. We generally blame politicians and administrators for the security lapses, but forget our own duty towards it. While security of the nation should remain the government's top priority, the common man can also contribute significantly if he acts conscientiously. Protecting India is a collective responsibility. SANJIV GUPTA, *Australia*

Red Shift

The problems that the Maoists claim to stand for can be solved only through dialogue and not by violence ("Equally Extreme", November 9). The Government has rightly asked the Maoists to abjure violence and

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